ROALLA



EXECUTIVE AI PORTFOLIO DECISION GUIDE

# AI Use Case Prioritization Guide 2026

## A disciplined method for selecting AI investments with credible value and delivery paths

Prepared for Chief executives, product, technology, operations, finance and transformation leaders

Prepared by ROALLA Transformation and Technology Advisory

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### Purpose

This guide helps leadership convert a long list of AI ideas into a governed investment portfolio. It separates attractive demonstrations from initiatives with a defensible customer problem, economic case, data foundation, implementation path and acceptable risk.

EXECUTIVE DECISION DASHBOARD

# Management View at a Glance

The best first AI use case is rarely the most technically impressive. It is the initiative with material value, a bounded workflow, accessible data, credible adoption, controlled risk and a short path to measurable evidence.

| Executive question | ROALLA view | Decision implication |
|---|---|---|
| **Is the idea tied to strategy?** | **CONDITIONAL** | Link the use case to a priority outcome, owner and baseline. |
| **Can value be measured quickly?** | **PURSUE** | Prefer initiatives with observable outcomes inside one or two operating cycles. |
| **Are feasibility and risk understood?** | **PREPARE** | Complete data, architecture, privacy, security and adoption screening. |
| **Is the portfolio balanced?** | **DECIDE** | Balance quick wins, foundational capabilities and selective strategic bets. |
| **What should management authorize?** | **PURSUE** | A scored use-case funnel and two controlled discovery sprints. |

## Recommended Management Posture

Proceed through a small number of explicit decision gates. Preserve evidence as work occurs, separate discovery from implementation, and require each investment to demonstrate value, feasibility, control effectiveness and accountable ownership before scale.

EXECUTIVE DECISION MODEL

# The Eight Use Case Selection Gates

Every idea must pass the same evidence standard before funding. Scoring supports comparison, but a hard failure in data authority, risk, ownership or feasibility overrides an attractive value score.

| Stage | Gate | Required conclusion | Decision evidence |
|---|---|---|---|
| **01** | Problem | Specific workflow or customer pain | Problem statement and baseline evidence |
| **02** | Value | Measurable economic or service outcome | Benefits model and accountable owner |
| **03** | Users | Clear users, decisions and adoption path | Journey, workflow and change hypothesis |
| **04** | Data | Accessible, lawful and sufficiently representative | Inventory, quality and authority review |
| **05** | Feasibility | Achievable integration and model approach | Architecture option and delivery estimate |
| **06** | Risk | Acceptable impact and controllability | Risk tier, mitigations and oversight |
| **07** | Evidence | Pilot can prove or disprove the thesis | Evaluation plan and success thresholds |
| **08** | Scale | Repeatable economics and operating ownership | Unit economics, service model and roadmap |

## Decision Rule

A failed hard gate moves the initiative to Prepare or Monitor. A strong narrative, senior sponsor or attractive market cannot replace missing authority, evidence, delivery capacity or operating control.

SECTION 01

# Readiness Framework

## Translate ambition into a shared executive view of value, evidence, capability and risk.



MANAGEMENT ASSESSMENT MODEL

# Readiness Dimensions

| Dimension | Decision area | Management evidence | Status |
|---|---|---|---|
| **01** | Strategic alignment | Priority outcome, sponsor and urgency | **Confirmed / Developing / Gap** |
| **02** | Value potential | Revenue, cost, risk, experience or capacity | **Confirmed / Developing / Gap** |
| **03** | Time to evidence | Speed to a decision-quality pilot result | **Confirmed / Developing / Gap** |
| **04** | Data readiness | Access, quality, authority and representativeness | **Confirmed / Developing / Gap** |
| **05** | Delivery feasibility | Architecture, skills, partners and integration | **Confirmed / Developing / Gap** |
| **06** | Risk and adoption | Impact, oversight, trust and workflow change | **Confirmed / Developing / Gap** |

## Evidence Standard

Assessments should distinguish verified evidence from management confidence. Where evidence is incomplete, record the gap, owner, completion date and decision that depends on it.

STRATEGIC READINESS DEPENDENCIES

# What Readiness Depends On

| Dependency | Why it matters | Evidence management should expect |
|---|---|---|
| **Problem** | Specific workflow or customer pain | Problem statement and baseline evidence |
| **Value** | Measurable economic or service outcome | Benefits model and accountable owner |
| **Users** | Clear users, decisions and adoption path | Journey, workflow and change hypothesis |
| **Data** | Accessible, lawful and sufficiently representative | Inventory, quality and authority review |
| **Feasibility** | Achievable integration and model approach | Architecture option and delivery estimate |
| **Risk** | Acceptable impact and controllability | Risk tier, mitigations and oversight |
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## ROALLA Interpretation

Dependencies should be evaluated as a connected system. A weakness in ownership, data, architecture, delivery or governance can change the economics and risk of an otherwise attractive initiative.

SECTION 02

# Detailed Readiness Assessment

## Convert executive intent into verifiable requirements, accountable evidence and clear remediation actions.



READINESS CHECKLIST

# Use Case Discovery Quality

**Completion standard** Mark Ready only when the supporting evidence has been verified. Assign an evidence owner to every open item.

| Gate | Readiness requirement | Ready | Gap | Evidence owner |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| A01 | The problem is observed in a defined customer or employee workflow. | ☐ | ☐ | _____ |
| A02 | A named business owner is accountable for the outcome and adoption. | ☐ | ☐ | _____ |
| A03 | The current baseline is measured using credible operational or customer data. | ☐ | ☐ | _____ |
| A04 | The proposed AI role is specific and narrower than the full process transformation. | ☐ | ☐ | _____ |
| A05 | Users and affected parties have been interviewed or observed. | ☐ | ☐ | _____ |
| A06 | The expected value is separated into revenue, cost, capacity, quality and risk effects. | ☐ | ☐ | _____ |
| A07 | Non-AI alternatives and simpler automation options have been considered. | ☐ | ☐ | _____ |
| A08 | The use case can be piloted without an irreversible platform commitment. | ☐ | ☐ | _____ |
| A09 | The organization can identify a clear decision at the end of discovery. | ☐ | ☐ | _____ |
| A10 | Dependencies on other programs, vendors, data and process changes are visible. | ☐ | ☐ | _____ |

READINESS CHECKLIST CONTINUED

# Prioritization and Portfolio Readiness

**Completion standard** Use Gap to create a dated remediation action and identify the management decision that cannot proceed.

| Gate | Readiness requirement | Ready | Gap | Evidence owner |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| B01 | All candidate use cases use the same scoring definitions and evidence standard. | ☐ | ☐ | _____ |
| B02 | Hard gates are assessed before weighted scores are compared. | ☐ | ☐ | _____ |
| B03 | Benefits are adjusted for adoption, delivery time, operating cost and confidence. | ☐ | ☐ | _____ |
| B04 | Data readiness is validated by accountable owners rather than assumed by sponsors. | ☐ | ☐ | _____ |
| B05 | Architecture estimates include integration, security, monitoring and support. | ☐ | ☐ | _____ |
| B06 | Privacy, safety, fairness and human-oversight requirements affect the score. | ☐ | ☐ | _____ |
| B07 | The portfolio identifies shared data, platform and governance enablers. | ☐ | ☐ | _____ |
| B08 | Quick wins do not crowd out foundational or strategically differentiating investments. | ☐ | ☐ | _____ |
| B09 | Each selected initiative has a discovery budget, owner, milestone and stop condition. | ☐ | ☐ | _____ |
| B10 | Management reviews actual results and re-ranks the portfolio at a defined cadence. | ☐ | ☐ | _____ |

WEIGHTED EXECUTIVE ASSESSMENT

# Readiness Scorecard

| Dimension | Weight | Evidence standard | Score | Status |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Strategic alignment** | 20% | Priority outcome, sponsor and urgency | __/20 | Strong / Developing / Gap |
| **Value potential** | 20% | Revenue, cost, risk, experience or capacity | __/20 | Strong / Developing / Gap |
| **Time to evidence** | 15% | Speed to a decision-quality pilot result | __/15 | Strong / Developing / Gap |
| **Data readiness** | 15% | Access, quality, authority and representativeness | __/15 | Strong / Developing / Gap |
| **Delivery feasibility** | 15% | Architecture, skills, partners and integration | __/15 | Strong / Developing / Gap |
| **Risk and adoption** | 15% | Impact, oversight, trust and workflow change | __/15 | Strong / Developing / Gap |
| **TOTAL** | 100% | Weighted executive assessment | __/100 | Pursue / Prepare / Monitor |

## Decision Thresholds

| Score | Posture | Management decision |
|---|---|---|
| **75 to 100** | **PURSUE** | Proceed to bounded execution subject to no hard-gate failure. |
| **50 to 74** | **PREPARE** | Complete a focused readiness plan before major commitment. |
| **0 to 49** | **MONITOR** | Resolve foundational gaps before investing further. |

A single material hard-gate failure overrides the weighted score. ROALLA also applies judgment where administrative readiness is high but strategic value, adoption or commercial viability is weak.

SECTION 03

# Execution and Advisory Roadmap

## Sequence decisions, evidence and delivery so management can invest with confidence and stop weak initiatives early.



# Recommended 90 Day Mobilization

| Timing | Focus | Key activities | Management output |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Days 1 to 15** | Mobilize | Confirm sponsor, scope, decision rights, evidence request and priority outcomes. | Approved mandate and fact base |
| **Days 16 to 35** | Assess | Review current evidence, interview owners, score readiness and identify hard gates. | Verified gaps and risk view |
| **Days 36 to 55** | Design | Define target operating, architecture, control and delivery options with economics. | Decision-ready options |
| **Days 56 to 75** | Validate | Test assumptions with users, data, technology, vendors and accountable control owners. | Evidence-backed recommendation |
| **Days 76 to 90** | Authorize | Approve the roadmap, owners, funding, measures, next gate and stop conditions. | Executive investment decision |

## Twelve to Twenty Four Month Path

- Quarter 1: establish the fact base, governance and one bounded priority initiative.
- Quarter 2: prove value and control effectiveness in a production-relevant pilot.
- Quarters 3 and 4: scale reusable capabilities, operating ownership and benefits realization.
- Year 2: optimize economics, institutionalize governance and refresh the portfolio using measured results.

ROALLA ADVISORY MODEL

# How ROALLA Can Help

ROALLA acts as the technology and commercialization advisor coordinating strategy, evidence, architecture, governance, partners and executive decisions. The objective is not to maximize activity. It is to direct management effort toward investments that are valuable, controllable and executable.

| ROALLA workstream | Executive value |
|---|---|
| **Executive diagnostic** | Establish the current fact base, hard gates, readiness score and management decisions. |
| **Strategy and portfolio** | Translate corporate priorities into a bounded, sequenced investment portfolio. |
| **Architecture and data** | Define target capabilities, integration, data, model, cloud and operating patterns. |
| **Governance and risk** | Design decision rights, policies, evidence, controls, monitoring and escalation. |
| **Commercial and financial case** | Model customer value, productivity, cost, funding, timing and benefits realization. |
| **Vendor and partner ecosystem** | Structure evaluation, sourcing, research, delivery and commercial relationships. |
| **Execution readiness** | Build roadmaps, work plans, budgets, measures, owners and decision gates. |
| **Ongoing assurance** | Monitor the portfolio, challenge evidence and bring decision-ready options to leadership. |

## Recommended Initial Mandate

- Four-week executive readiness diagnostic using this guide.
- Prioritized decision and evidence map with Pursue, Prepare and Monitor recommendations.
- One flagship initiative dossier with roadmap, economics, architecture and control plan.
- Executive readout and 90-day mobilization plan with accountable owners.

CONTROL FRAMEWORK

# Key Risks and Controls

| Risk | Exposure | ROALLA control |
|---|---|---|
| **Idea volume** | The loudest sponsor wins the portfolio. | Use one evidence standard and transparent scoring. |
| **Solution bias** | Teams select technology before defining the problem. | Start with workflow, outcome and alternatives. |
| **Inflated value** | Benefits ignore adoption, time and operating cost. | Apply confidence and realization adjustments. |
| **Hidden data gap** | Data access and quality are assumed. | Require owner-confirmed data evidence. |
| **Pilot theatre** | A demonstration cannot support a scale decision. | Define production-relevant tests and thresholds. |
| **Risk blindness** | Impact is assessed after selection. | Classify risk before ranking. |
| **Fragmentation** | Use cases create duplicate platforms and controls. | Prioritize shared enablers and architecture patterns. |
| **No exit** | Weak initiatives continue because of sunk cost. | Use explicit stop, pivot and scale gates. |

## Professional Advice

Qualified legal, privacy, security, tax, accounting, employment and regulatory advisors should validate matters within their professional scope. ROALLA coordinates those inputs with technology strategy, architecture, commercialization, governance and transformation decisions.

OFFICIAL EVIDENCE BASE

# Selected Official Sources

These sources support the management principles summarized in this guide. Standards, laws, guidance and organizational obligations continue to evolve and must be confirmed for the specific context before acting.

**NIST AI Risk Management Framework.** Official source — Voluntary framework for governing, mapping, measuring and managing AI risk.
**NIST Generative AI Profile.** Official source — Companion risk profile for generative AI systems and use cases.
**ISO IEC 42001 AI management systems.** Official source — Management-system approach for responsible AI governance and continual improvement.
**Office of the Privacy Commissioner of Canada AI guidance.** Official source — Canadian privacy guidance for organizations developing or using AI.
**Government of Canada Digital Standards.** Official source — User-centred, secure, accessible and iterative digital-service principles.

## Advisory Disclaimer

This ROALLA guide is a strategic readiness and marketing document. It is not a certification, audit opinion, legal opinion, privacy opinion, security assurance, investment recommendation or guarantee of results. Management must validate current obligations, company facts and professional advice before making material decisions.